First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Tuesday - Friday 9am-2pm
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: Friday 9:30am - Noon
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Rich Guzman
Acolytes: Mykala Pryor and Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

January 19, 2025

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Bailey Brown, Choir & Music Director
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Stephen McLaughlin, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Baptism of Christ Sunday January 19, 2025

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words:
Miracles are a retelling in small letters of the very same story which is written across the whole world in letters too large for some of us to see. — C. S. Lewis

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude
Welcome and Announcements

Sung Call To Worship Come and Fill Our Hearts (Taizé)

Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
You alone, O God, are holy.
Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
Al-le-lu--ia!

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

Magnificent God, we come to draw near to you. Your presence among us sustains and challenges us. In you, we find strength and surprises. May the songs we sing, the prayers we pray, the word proclaimed, and the lives touched honor your name. We give you glory and honor. We welcome you and pray that your spirit shapes us with fresh wind, power, and compassion. Amen.

Hymn*

Help Us Accept Each Other NCH 388

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways
Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and nonperishable food items.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
First Congregational Church of St Albans
Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
St. Luke's Episcopal Church, St. Albans
Sheldon Interfaith Food Shelf
Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
Congregational Church of So. Hero
Our local Girl Scout Troop

As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:

F/GI Community Action
Voices Against Violence
Samaritan House
Restorative Justice Center
Pathways
Reach-Up
Spectrum Youth and Family Services

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

Prayer of Transformation[1] **(Unison)**
Gracious God, we live in the tension between expectation and reality. Sometimes, we navigate that tension with hope and clarity. At other times, we fester in doubt, disappointment, and uncertainty. Help us to release our need to control and enable us to embrace the possibilities. May our trust in your goodness and the power you have poured into us embolden our faith. Amen.

Pause for Reflection
Words of Assurance
Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Time with Children

Anthem Navy Hymn: *Eternal Father, Strong to Save*

Scripture Reading John 2:1-11

Contemporary Reading from *A Summer's Day* Mary Oliver

Morning Reflection

A Wee Nudge

Hymn*

Precious Lord, Take My Hand NCH 472

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns
Choral Call To Prayer
"*Hear Our Prayer, O Lord*" D. Welpton
Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

Choral Response To Prayer

"Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee."

Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

Lift Every Voice and Sing NCH 593

Benediction

Postlude

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

★ Nancy Newton, Jessica Pecor, Rachael Carr, and Doug Klette, aka the NEW Faith Formation Committee, Thank You for offering your leadership in this vital area!

Martha's Kitchen Collection

Shopping List:

Coffee
Iced Tea Mix
Sugar
Powdered Creamer

Zoom Bible Study: Companionship on the Road
Wednesdays 7:00-8:00pm
Jan. 22
Luke 4:14-21
Contact Pastor Jessica for the link.

Online Giving:
Wi-Fi:
Fellowship Hall
fellowship123

